

Tell me about yourself:

I'm Dan Baglini, originally from northern Rhode Island. I studied mathematics and finance at the University of Rhode Island, where I developed a strong foundation in structured problem-solving and quantitative thinking.

After college, I joined the Army as an intelligence officer because I wanted early leadership responsibility and the chance to make decisions with real consequences. I spent four and a half years in Vicenza, Italy, where across several progressively senior roles I led cross-functional teams supporting U.S., NATO, and Ukrainian military leaders.

My work ranged from training allied forces to managing intelligence operations in Ukraine and leading a 24-person platoon focused on threat analysis and response planning. Across all of these roles, I learned how to distill complex, ambiguous information into clear, actionable recommendations for senior decision-makers.

I'm now at Yale pursuing my MBA to build my business toolkit and transition to the private sector. I'm excited about consulting because it mirrors what I've enjoyed most in the Army; solving complex problems, working in teams, and driving impact at scale, while allowing me to apply those skills across industries.

Why McKinsey:

McKinsey stands out for two reasons: development and impact. First, the apprenticeship model means continuous growth, I've already seen it through my case buddy and SOM alumni. I'll develop like I did in the military, but alongside mentors like Andrew and Zach. Second, McKinsey's reach, solving complex problems for top firms, means I can have large-scale impact from day one. That combination is exactly what I'm after.

Why Consulting:

Consulting is the fastest way for me to compound my learning while working on real, high-stakes problems.

Coming from the Army, I've seen how structured problem-solving and good decision-making can dramatically change outcomes, but I've also seen how often organizations lack that capability. Consulting lets me help leaders diagnose ambiguous problems, build fact-based answers, and actually drive change across different contexts.

Long-term, I'm interested in leadership roles that bridge business and the public sector. Consulting gives me a rigorous toolkit, exposure across industries, and a bias toward impact that I wouldn't get as quickly anywhere else.

Why Darien:

Darien is a strong fit for me both professionally and culturally

Professionally, Darien's client mix; especially in financial services, defense, and the broader Northeast market, aligns well with my interests and background. I'm excited by work that combines analytical rigor with complex stakeholder environments.

Culturally, every Darien consultant I've spoken with emphasized how tight-knit and apprenticeship-oriented the office is. As someone who thrived in small, high-trust teams in the military, that matters a lot to me.